

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: A Tragic Double Murder Occurred



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe rules and obligations through a wider range of language and expressions in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you or anyone you know been affected by a crime?
- What do you think should happen to people who have committed a crime?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about rules, regulations, crime and punishment.
- I can write a short narrative paragraph.
- I can write about things I had done or things that had happened.





Let's Explore!

Detective* Johnson is awoken by a phone call. There has been a tragic accident on **Marina**** Road.

* A "detective" is a police officer whose job is to find information about crimes.

** A "marina" is an area of water where you find privately owned boats.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Detective Johnson woke up to the phone ringing.

"There's been a double murder at 31 Marina Road. Come quickly," said the sergeant.

When Johnson arrived at the scene, the forensic people had already been there for an hour. They had dusted for fingerprints, and collected hair and blood samples from the carpet in the living room, where the murders had been committed. The samples were taken back to the lab by the team.

Johnson walked over to the bodies. They were married hosts Tom and Mary from the popular "Good Afternoon" show. He had only seen them on television the day before.

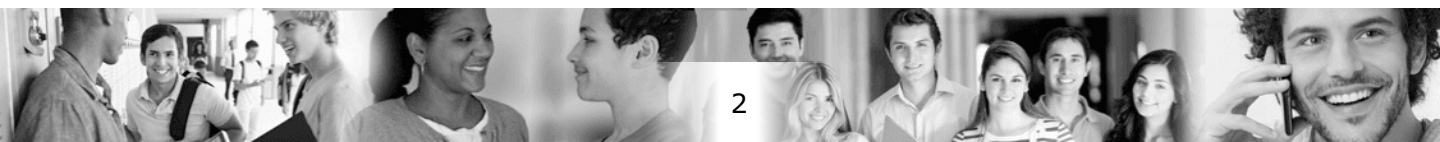
A gun lay near Mary's hand. Johnson could tell by the position of the body and the bullet hole in Tom's chest, that Mary had killed Tom. But who had killed Mary? There were pieces of a broken bottle on the ground. Mary had a big wound in the back of her head.

Two days after the murders, the detective was called by the lab to say the results from the samples they had collected were ready. There were no usable fingerprints but they had found blood samples that didn't belong to Tom or Mary.

Also, they determined that some DNA partially matched Tom's. That meant that the killer was probably one of Tom's relatives! He got right onto the investigative work.

Tom's father was dead and he didn't have siblings. That left only his mother. She had lived down the street from Tom and Mary for years. When the police arrived at her door, they found her very distraught. She confessed that when she arrived at their house that day, she found Tom and Mary arguing about money. Mary was threatening to kill him. When Tom's mother heard Mary threatening her son, she took a bottle and smashed it over Mary's head. The gun went off and killed Tom by accident.

Tom's mother was remanded into custody by Johnson. What a tragic end for these public figures.





Let's Practice!

Detective Johnson is on the case.

Instructions: Complete the sentences using the words in the box.

Word Bank

had / does / had already / had seen / had dusted /
had / had lived / living

1. When Johnson arrived at the scene, the forensic people _____ been there for an hour.
2. They _____ for fingerprints, and collected hair and blood samples from the carpet in the living room.
3. He _____ seen them on television only the day before.
4. Johnson could tell by the position of the body and the bullet hole in Tom's chest, that Mary _____ killed Tom.
5. She _____ down the street from Tom and Mary for years.



Let's Practice!

Can you write a short detective story?

Instructions: Write a 120-180 word narrative about a detective. Use paragraph structure. Include 2-3 paragraphs. A narrative needs characters, a setting and a clear problem to be interesting to an audience.

Step 1. Beginning: Decide who is the narrator. (Who is speaking) Choose the characters and the setting. (Where and When) Write the problem the detective faces.

Step 2. Middle: What happens?

Step 3. End: What is the solution to the problem or conflict?





Extension Activity

Did you see that terrible crime on television last night?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 12-14 line dialogue about a crime.
- Describe the event and what happened.
- Include two sentences that use the structure *had* + the past participle.
- Include two sentences that use the Simple Past Passive.
- Read the dialogue aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a dialogue about a crime.

☐ ☐

I read a dialogue about a crime to a partner.

☐ ☐

I describe something done by someone at sometime in the past.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **murder** (noun): the crime of deliberately killing a person
e.g. There had been a double murder.
- **body** (noun): the physical structure of a dead person or animal
e.g. A body was found near the river.
- **blood sample** (noun): a small amount of blood to be tested
e.g. He had to give a blood sample at the police station.
- **custody** (noun): the state of being kept in a prison or jail
e.g. She was placed in custody.
- **fingerprint** (noun): the mark that is made by pressing the tip of a finger on a surface
e.g. Have you had your fingerprints taken before?
- **DNA** (noun): a substance that carries genetic information
e.g. Your DNA is a combination of your parents' genetic material.
- **to dust** (verb): to cover a surface with fine powder
e.g. She dusted for fingerprints at the crime scene.
- **to confess** (verb): to admit that you did something wrong or illegal
e.g. She confessed to the terrible crime.
- **to threaten** (verb): to say that you will harm someone or do something unpleasant
e.g. She threatened him with a bottle.
- **to remand** (verb): to order someone to go somewhere
e.g. His mother was remanded into custody.





Learning Points

Past Perfect Tense

You use the Past Perfect to express an idea that something occurred before another action in the past. It can also show that something happened before a specific time in the past.

You form the tense by using the past tense form of "to have"(had) plus the past participle of the verb.

had + past participle of verb

Here are some examples below.

Event A	Event B
<i>The lab crew had left the scene</i>	<i>by the time I arrived.</i>
<i>I had saved him a spot at the table</i>	<i>before he showed up.</i>
Event B	Event A
<i>The detective was very tired</i>	<i>because he had been working the late shift.</i>
<i>When they arrived</i>	<i>we had already started the investigation.</i>





Learning Points

Simple Past Passive

When you are writing a news article or giving an interview, you can include the Simple Past Passive to describe something done by someone at sometime in the past.

In a regular sentence structure, you use Subject + verb + object.

Example:

Governing bodies never properly carried out regulations regarding pollution.

In the Simple Past Passive form, you use the structure:

Object + was / were + past participle + by Subject

Example:

Regulations regarding pollution were never properly carried out by any governing body.

Examples:

- *The samples were taken back to the lab by the team.*
- *Tom's mother was remanded into custody by Johnson.*

